



CITY COUNCIL MEETING MINUTES

January 14, 2025

CALL TO ORDER:

The Jackson City Council met in regular session in Council Chambers and was called to order at 6:30 p.m. by Mayor Daniel Mahoney.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE AND INVOCATION:

Council joined in the Pledge of Allegiance. Invocation was given by Third Ward Councilmember Angelita Gunn.

ROLL CALL:

Present: Mayor Daniel Mahoney, Vice Mayor/Second Ward Councilmember Freddie Dancy, Third Ward Councilmember Angelita Gunn, Fourth Ward Councilmember Conner Wood, Fifth Ward Councilmember Christy Davis, and Sixth Ward Councilmember Will Forgrave.

First Ward Councilmember Arlene Robinson arrived after the initial roll call.

Absent: none.

Also present: City Manager Jonathan Greene, City Attorney Matthew Hagerty, City Clerk Andrea Muray, City Assessor Jason Yoakam, Director of Community Development Shane LaPorte, Deputy Police Chief Sergio Garcia, and City Engineer Troy White.

ADOPTION OF AGENDA:

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Vice Mayor Dancy to adopt the agenda.

Motion was made by Councilmember Davis, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to amend the agenda to add Item 9A – City Manager update on TA Wilson. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Councilmembers Gunn, Wood, David, and Forgrave (5). Nays: Vice Mayor Dancy (1). Motion carried.

Vote was taken on adoption of the agenda as amended. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

PRESENTATIONS/PROCLAMATIONS: none.

PUBLIC HEARINGS:

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to recess as City Council and convene as the Board of Review. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

A. Special Assessment Roll No. 3444 Confirmation Hearing

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to open the public hearing. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

Darren Buehrer of 600 E Pearl Street spoke in opposition of the amount of the proposed assessment. Larry Filipczak of 615 Pearl Street spoke in opposition of the amount of the proposed assessment.

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to close the public hearing. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded for discussion by Mayor Mahoney to approve the Special Assessment Roll No. 3444. Vote – Yeas: none. Nays: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Motion failed

B. Special Assessment Roll No. 3450 Confirmation Hearing

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to open the public hearing. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

No comments were offered.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to close the public hearing. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded for discussion by Councilmember Robinson approve a resolution to confirm Special Assessment Roll No. 3450. Vote – Yeas: Councilmember Wood (1). Nays: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Davis, and Forgrave (6). Motion failed.

Motion was made Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to adjourn as the Board of Review and reconvene as City Council. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

C. Citizen Comment on the City’s Housing and Community Development Needs

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to open the public hearing to receive citizen comment on the City’s Housing and Community Development Needs. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

John Leicht spoke in support of the City’s work with the 100 Homes Program. Nathan Williams spoke in regards of the needs of landlords and opportunities the City could utilize in supporting them. John King spoke to his analysis of the City’s homeless population and services being provided.

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to close the public hearing. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

CITIZEN COMMENTS:

Citizen comments were heard and the meeting continued.

CONSENT CALENDAR:

A. Minutes of the December 10, 2024 Regular Meeting of the Jackson City Council

Approve the minutes of the regular meeting held on December 10, 2024

B. Change to the Standard Lighting Contract with Consumers Energy for Installation of a Streetlight.

Approve the Resolution for Change to the Standard Lighting Contract with Consumers Energy for the addition of a streetlight at 908 George Street and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents.

C. Change to the Standard Lighting Contract with Consumers Energy for Installation of a Streetlight.

Approve the Resolution for Change to the Standard Lighting Contract with Consumers Energy for the addition of a streetlight at 908 George Street and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents.

D. Reappointments to the Martin Luther King Corridor Improvement Authority

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to reappoint Philicia Richmond and Anthony Parker to the Martin Luther King Corridor Improvement Authority for a term of 4 years, beginning immediately and expiring on 12/31/28.

E. Reappointment to the Racial Equity Commission

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to reappoint Leticia Albarran to the Racial Equity Commission for a term of 3 years, expiring on 12/31/27.

F. Receipt of Michigan Liquor Control Commission application for transfer of membership interest

Accept and place on file the notice from the MLCC regarding the transfer of membership interest for MCGA, LLC at 128 W Michigan Avenue

G. City of Jackson, Michigan Financial Statements for the Five Months Ended November 30, 2024

H. Edward Byrne Memorial Justice Assistance Grant (JAG Grant) Public Hearing

Schedule a Public Hearing for the Edward Byrne Memorial Justice Assistance Grant to be held at the January 28, 2025, City Council meeting.

I. Assessor's Office Update

Receive the 2024 End of Year Informational Report

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Vice Mayor Dancy to approve the consent calendar. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

OTHER BUSINESS:

A. City Manager Update on T. A. Wilson

City Manager Jonathan Greene provided Council with an update on the status of the sale of T. A. Wilson.

NEW BUSINESS:

A. JNET Interlocal Agreement

Recommendation: *Approve JNET Interlocal Agreement*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to approve the JNET Interlocal Agreement. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

B. Deficit Elimination Plan Resolution as of June 30, 2024, for the Special Assessment Capital Project Fund

Recommendation: *Approval of the deficit elimination plan resolution for the special assessment capital project fund as of June 30, 2024.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the deficit elimination plan resolution for the special assessment capital project fund as of June 30, 2024. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

C. Professional Engineering Services Contract with Fishbeck, to prepare the Fiscal Year 2026 Drinking Water State Revolving Fund (DWSRF) Project Plan.

Recommendation: *Approval of Professional Engineering Services Contract with Fishbeck, to prepare the Fiscal Year 2026 Drinking Water State Revolving Fund (DWSRF) Project Plan at a not to exceed amount of \$74,250.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the Professional Engineering Services Contract with Fishbeck, to prepare the Fiscal Year 2026 Drinking Water State Revolving Fund Project Plan at a not to exceed amount of \$74,250. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

D. 2025/2026 City of Jackson Rubbish Removal Contract from City Facilities.

Recommendation: *Approve the City of Jackson Facilities Rubbish Removal Contract for \$81,984 for the two-year contract to Granger Waste Services of Lansing, Michigan.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to approve the City of Jackson Facilities Rubbish Removal Contract for \$81,984 for the two-year contract to Granger Waste Services of Lansing, Michigan. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

E. 2025 Parks, Cemeteries, Downtown, and Trails Mowing and Irrigation Renewal Contract.

Recommendation: *Approve the 2025 Parks, Cemeteries, Downtown, and Trails Mowing and Irrigation Renewal Contract for \$269,570.43 to Picture Perfect Lawn Care LLC of Concord, Michigan.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the 2025 Parks, Cemeteries, Downtown, and Trails Mowing and Irrigation Renewal Contract for \$269,570.43 to Picture Perfect Lawn Care LLC of Concord, Michigan. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Davis, and Forgrave (6). Nays: Councilmember Wood (1). Motion carried.

F. Resolution – MDOT Contract for Traffic Signal Modernizations

Recommendation: *Approve a resolution to enter into a contract with the Michigan Department of Transportation (MDOT) for traffic signal modernizations on Morrell Street at the intersection with Brown Street and the intersection with Wisner Street and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to approve a resolution to enter into a contract with the Michigan Department of Transportation for traffic signal modernizations on Morrell Street at the intersection with Brown Street and the intersection with Wisner Street and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to sign the proper documents. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

G. MDOT Annual Permit for Miscellaneous Operations – Performance Resolution.

Recommendation: *Approve a Performance Resolution for Municipalities for the 2025 Annual Application and Permit for Miscellaneous Operations within State Highway Right-of-Way, authorize the City Clerk to sign the resolution document and authorize the City Engineer to execute the annual permit.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve a Performance Resolution for Municipalities for the 2025 Annual Application and Permit for Miscellaneous Operations within State Highway Right-of-Way, authorize the City Clerk to sign the resolution document and authorize the City Engineer to execute the annual permit. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

H. Contract Award for Professional Services - Tree Inventory and Management Plan.

Recommendation: *Approve the award of the Tree Inventory and Management Plan professional services contract to Eocene Environmental Group, Inc. of West Des Moines, Iowa at a cost of \$60,493.17 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the award of the Tree Inventory and Management Plan professional services contract to Eocene Environmental Group, Inc. of West Des Moines, Iowa at a cost of \$60,493.17 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

I. Amendment 3 to the Professional Engineering Services contract with Fishbeck.

Recommendation: *Approval of Amendment 3 to the CWSRF Professional Engineering Services contract with Fishbeck, Inc. of Grand Rapids, Michigan in the amount of \$41,376.00, and authorization for the City Manager and City Engineer to sign the appropriate document.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve Amendment 3 to the CWSRF Professional Engineering Services contract with Fishbeck, Inc. of Grand Rapids in the amount of \$41,376.00, and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to sign the appropriate document. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

J. Change Order 1 to the 2024 Water Services Replacement contract with Dunigan Brothers, Inc.

Recommendation: *Approve Change Order 1 to the 2024 Water Services Replacement contract with Dunigan Brothers, Inc. in the decreased amount of \$168,752.32 to balance contract quantities to match quantities placed in the field and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded Councilmember Forgrave to approve Change Order 1 to the 2024 Water Services Replacement contract with Dunigan Brothers, Inc. in the decreased amount of \$168,752.32 to balance contract quantities to match quantities placed in the field and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

K. Change Order 2 to the Blakely Avenue Reconstruction contract with Bailey Excavating, Inc.

Recommendation: *Approve Change Order 2 to the Blakely Avenue Reconstruction contract with Bailey Excavating, Inc. in the increased amount of \$8,259.15 to balance contract quantities to match quantities placed in the field and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded Councilmember Robinson to approve Change Order 2 to the Blakely Avenue Reconstruction contract with Bailey Excavating, Inc. in the increased amount of \$8,259.15 to balance contract quantities to match quantities placed in the field and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

L. Amendment 4 to the 2022 Major Street Engineering Contract.

Recommendation: *Approve Amendment 4 to the 2022 Major Street Engineering contract with Spalding DeDecker Associates, Inc. (SDA) of Novi, Michigan at a not-to-exceed cost of \$42,725.00 and authorization for the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate documents.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve Amendment 4 to the 2022 Major Street Engineering contract with Spalding DeDecker Associates, Inc. of Novi, Michigan at a not-to-exceed cost of \$42,725.00 and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate documents. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

M. Contract Award – Pearl Loop Transmission Main.

Recommendation: *Approve the award of the Pearl Loop Transmission Main contract to Dunigan Brothers, Inc. of Jackson, Michigan at a cost of \$7,549,605.37 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the award of the Pearl Loop Transmission Main contract to Dunigan Brothers, Inc. of Jackson, Michigan at a cost of \$7,549,605.37 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

N. Contract Award for Hazardous Tree Removal Program.

Recommendation: *Approve the award of the Hazardous Tree Removal Program contract to Top Notch Tree Care, LLC of Leslie, Michigan at a cost of \$106,850.00 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded Councilmember Robinson to approve the award of the Hazardous Tree Removal Program contract to Top Notch Tree Care, LLC of Leslie, Michigan at a cost of \$106,850.00 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

O. Contract Award for Water Treatment Plant Sanitary Sewer Replacement

Recommendation: *Approve the award of the Water Treatment Plant Sanitary Sewer Replacement contract to Bailey Excavating, Inc. of Jackson, Michigan at a cost of \$611,953.00 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the award of the Water Treatment Plant Sanitary Sewer Replacement contract to Bailey Excavating, Inc. of Jackson, Michigan at a cost of \$611,953.00 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

P. Easement to Consumers Energy – 300 S. Cooper

Recommendation: *Approval of an easement to Consumers Energy on city-owned property at 300 South Cooper Street (Parcel ID 5-0270) for gas service piping and authorization for the City Manager to sign the easement document.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve an easement to Consumers Energy on city-owned property at 300 South Cooper Street for gas service piping and authorization for the City Manager to sign the easement document. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

Q. Accept the donation of vacant residential property on Hobart Street.

Recommendation: *Accept the donation of vacant residential property on Hobart Street (parcel #s 8-2529, 8-2530, and 8-2531), approve the donation agreement and quit claim deed, authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications as needed, and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to execute the appropriate documents necessary to complete the transaction.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Councilmember Wood to accept the donation of vacant residential property on Hobart Street, approve the donation agreement and quit claim deed, authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications as needed, and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to execute the appropriate documents necessary to complete the transaction. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

CITY COUNCILMEMBER’S COMMENTS:

Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, and Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave all offered comments.

MANAGER’S COMMENTS:

City Manager Jonathan Greene offered comments.

ADJOURNMENT:

No further business being offered, a motion to adjourn was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Mayor Mahoney. Mayor Mahoney adjourned the meeting at 9:01 p.m.